



ADOPTION PLANNER • NINETY DAYS

The 90-Day Small-Business AI Adoption *Planner*

A smaller business does not need a three-year programme. It needs ninety controlled days that build evidence, capability and momentum. Work the three phases in order, and assign an owner to every line.

DAYS 1 TO 30 Understand

Get an honest picture before you touch a tool. Almost every failed adoption skipped this.

☐	Agree the leadership objective What is AI in service of? One sentence everything later is judged against.	OWNER _____
☐	Surface the AI already in use Including the quiet, unofficial kind. Without blame: it is your best evidence of what helps.	OWNER _____
☐	Run a light risk discovery What data must never be pasted in, and where a confident wrong answer could do harm.	OWNER _____
☐	List candidate workflows The frequent, worthwhile, checkable tasks where AI is likely to help.	OWNER _____
☐	Take a baseline measure How long the chosen work takes today, or how often it goes wrong. No baseline, no proof later.	OWNER _____

BY THE END OF PHASE ONE

A one-sentence objective, a map of current use, a written data rule, a shortlist of workflows, and a **baseline you can measure against.**



DAYS 31 TO 60 **Build**

One or two pieces of work actually change. Two is a deliberate ceiling, not a starting point.

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|--------------------------|--|----------------|
| ☐ | Select no more than two use cases
The best balance of value and low risk from your phase-one shortlist. | OWNER
_____ |
| ☐ | Create reusable instructions and context
The standing prompt, house style, examples and definitions, so the work is owned by the business, not one person. | OWNER
_____ |
| ☐ | Test with a small group
Include someone sceptical, not just the enthusiasts. | OWNER
_____ |
| ☐ | Record the failures honestly
They are the most valuable output of the month: they show where human checks belong. | OWNER
_____ |
| ☐ | Establish human approval
Which outputs a person must check, and who that person is, before anything goes live. | OWNER
_____ |

BY THE END OF PHASE TWO

One or two workflows running on **reusable, owned instructions**, tested by real people, with the failure modes known and the human checks placed.



DAYS 61 TO 90 **Adopt**

Decide whether this survives contact with normal working life.

☐	Train the people who do the work Use your own real examples from the build phase, not a generic course.	OWNER _____
☐	Formalise the workflow Write the short version of how it now runs, so it does not live only in one head.	OWNER _____
☐	Measure results against the baseline Be honest if the answer is disappointing. That honesty is the point.	OWNER _____
☐	Assign ownership A named person responsible for keeping the workflow healthy as the tools change.	OWNER _____

THEN DECIDE, FOR EACH USE CASE

Stop It did not earn its place. Say so plainly and free up the attention.	Improve Promising but not there. Run another short cycle on the weak point.	Scale It worked. Widen it deliberately, with the checks and ownership intact.
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Discuss a 90-Day Adoption Build

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